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What is a Lead Broker?

By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer
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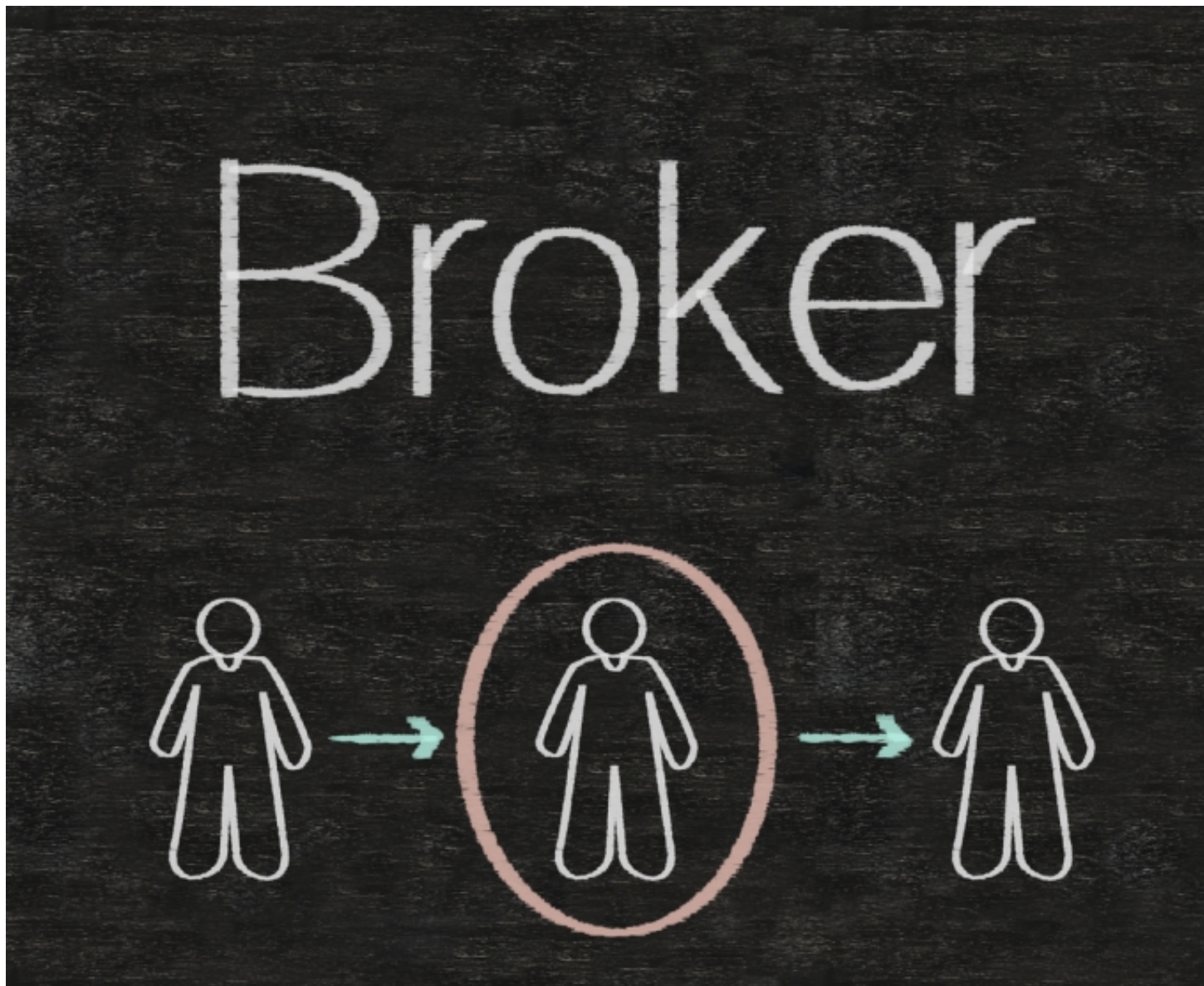
As an affiliate marketer, you deal mostly in lead generation. But, if you're not working directly with an affiliate network or a lead buyer, you may find yourself in need of a lead broker.

Lead brokers are intermediaries between lead generators and lead buyers. While similar in function to an affiliate network, a lead broker can potentially deal with multiple niches and industries where an affiliate network usually deals with one specific niche.

Generally, a lead broker is a company, not just one person. The broker deals with many lead generators and lead buyers, overseeing deals between the two. This process can smooth relations between the seller and buyer, streamlining leads purchases for those not working directly with affiliate networks.

Lead brokers can help lead buyers rent leads lists, or purchase exclusive leads. To a lead supplier, the lead broker may seem like an unnecessary go-between. But, if a lead supplier wants the best return on lead-generation costs, and the largest potential buying pool, it may be smart to seek out a lead broker.

It may help to better understand the lead suppliers and lead buyers and the necessary involvement between the two parties that a lead broker helps mediate.



Lead Suppliers

Lead suppliers go by many names: Lead generators, affiliate marketers, lead originators and performance marketers are all common alternative names. No matter the name, the result is the same. Lead suppliers gather and sell lead information to buyers. Lead information can be a list of prospective customers' phone numbers, mailing addresses, email addresses or a mix of all three.

The lead information is usually sorted by categories. Lead suppliers may organize their lists by geographic information, demographics, buying intent and niche interest.

Lead Buyers

A lead buyer's role can be as varied as the niche for which you generate leads. Some lead buyers are lenders, some are merchants and some operate service businesses.

A lead broker helps buyers connect with suppliers whose leads are the best fit. Lead buyers may also be inclined to work with a lead broker to help safeguard themselves from scams. "With the rise of LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook, etc etc ... more and more so-called 'lead generators' are [resorting to spam](#) as a way to get your [sic] to buy leads from them," says TaeWoo of Solar One Media. A reliable lead broker can shield you from these shady lead providers.



Lead Management Software

Managing various lists of leads is integral to a lead broker's success. Meticulous attention to detail is paramount for a lead broker to excel at mediating deals between generators and buyers. There are dozens of list management solutions to choose from for those in need of a little help keeping leads organized.

As seems to be the standard, list management software goes by many names. List management, lead management, customer relationship management, all perform the same basic function, yet each offers its own spin on keeping track of your leads.

Software will help automate the process of lead management, but Entrepreneur magazine offers a [few tips](#) on the business management side of lead list cultivation. The list includes sage advice such as nurturing your leads, treating your prospects as if they are already your customer and holding regular meetings with your sales staff to keep everyone on the same page.

Lead Broker Takeaway

Even if you are an affiliate marketer and have no wish to become a lead broker, it is still important to know what one is and the duties that role encompasses. If you are in any way involved in the lead generation business, there is a good chance you will be closely involved with a lead broker at some point in your career.

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Chaz Wilke

Content Writer

Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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